

are valued. Ownership of two of the IPL's oldest franchises changed hands recently. Consortium led by steel tycoon Lakshmi N. Mittal and Aditya Mittal (75%) along with Adar Poonawala (18%) has acquired 93% ownership of RR, valuing the franchise at approximately ₹15,660 crores. RCB was sold to a consortium of Aditya Birla Group, Times of India Group, Bolt Ventures, and Blackstone for roughly ₹16,660 crore.

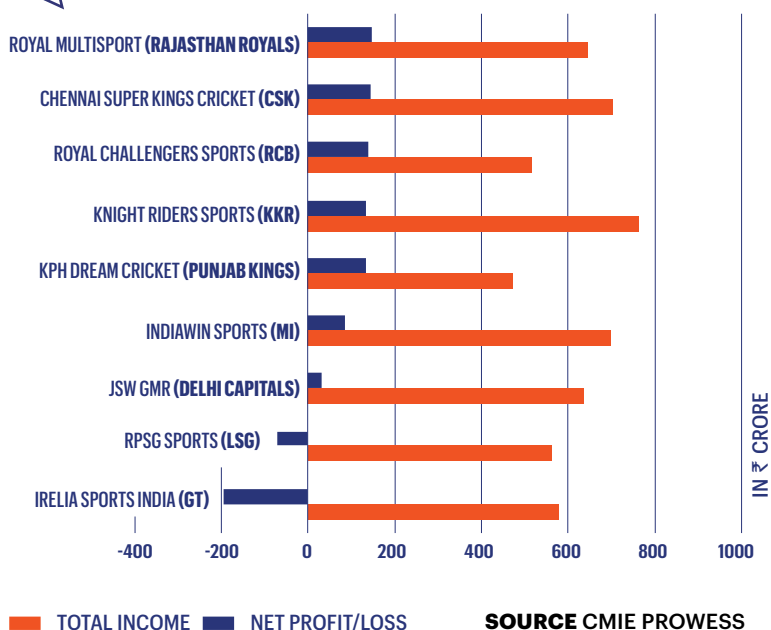
For the longest time, IPL franchise valuations existed in a grey zone. Everyone knew these were valuable assets, but there was no consistent benchmark. One earlier reference point came in March last year when the Torrent Group acquired a 67% stake in GT from CVC Capital, valuing the relatively new franchise around ₹7,500 crore.

Chennai Super Kings (CSK) has traditionally served as the reference point, with no ownership changes, no stock exchange listing, but quite active in the unlisted share market. With 379.4 million equity shares outstanding as of March 31, 2025, and unlisted trades hovering around ₹300 per share, CSK's implied valuation stands at roughly ₹11,500 crore.

The two recent deals, however, finally put a clear price on what IPL franchises are worth, confirming that they are neither vanity buys nor mere branding proxies, but a genuine asset class. "What makes this (RCB deal) particularly interesting is the nature of the buyer consortiums: Blackstone, Aditya Birla Group, and NFL franchise owners are not speculative buyers. These are institutional, longer-duration capital allocators making a



FINANCIALS OF IPL TEAMS



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